



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Marketing & Numbers · Launch Case CLIENT LANE

Planning brief session 4 · build from session 8 · 40 students · 8 teams · courses: GBBS445, GBCF435, GBMK444, GBMN441, GBST442, GRQR316, GCIC313

What your team is building

A real product or service launch planned end to end for a client firm — strategy, marketing, management, finance, statistics — with a launch experiment run for real in the four areas; the case goes to the client and the authority.

ONE PROJECT, SEVERAL GRADEBOOKS

You submit **one** piece of work, and each course that marks it looks at a different dimension, out of 20. **At most eight courses mark one team file.** A course you take that falls outside those eight sets you a **lens note** instead — an individual piece on the same project from that course's angle, 3,000 words, same rubric, same 20 marks. No student carries more than two: from a third, that course marks your viva out of 30 instead.

YOUR MARKS FROM THIS PROJECT

30 the project — a team mark of 20 from each course that marks your file, plus your own viva of 10, held in class in session 14

30 the mid-term

40 the final

The three quizzes are practice and carry no marks.

This replaces coursework, not classes.

What each course marks

CODE	COURSE	WHAT THIS COURSE MARKS — 20 MARKS
GBBS445	Global Business Strategy Mohammad Ali Saeed	This course marks the strategy: the industry and competitor read behind the launch, the position claimed and what defends it, the fit with the client's resources, the export or expansion option assessed, and the risks named with a response set against each. 20 marks, team.
GBCF435	Corporate Finance Dr Rakesh Parkash	This course marks the money: the cost and revenue model behind the launch, the funding requirement and where it comes from, the discount rate and how it was arrived at, the NPV and break-even, and the sensitivity analysis showing what the case depends on. 20 marks, team.
GBMK444	Principles of Marketing Saria Ali Khan	This course marks the market case: the segmentation and the segment chosen, the positioning against a named competitor, the marketing mix and its internal consistency, the launch plan and its budget, and the measures set to judge whether it worked. 20 marks, team.



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Marketing & Numbers · Launch Case CLIENT LANE

continued

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GBMN441	Principles of Management Rukhsar	This course marks the plan and the running of it: the objectives and how success will be judged, the schedule and who owns each part, the structure and decision rights inside the team, the risks and the controls set against them, and evidence of how the team actually worked. 20 marks, team.
GBST442	Statistical Inference Zaeem Farooqui	This course marks the evidence: how the market claim was turned into a testable hypothesis, the sampling plan and its limits, the test chosen and why, the assumption checks, the effect size reported alongside the p-value, and the honesty of the conclusion drawn. 20 marks, team.
GRQR316	Quantitative Reasoning I To be assigned	This course marks the arithmetic underneath the launch case: the sizing and estimation, the ratios and percentage changes reported, the descriptive statistics on the survey data, the honesty of the charts, and whether every figure in the document can be reproduced from the workings. 20 marks, team.
GCIC313	Applications of Information & Communication Technologies TEACHER TO BE NAMED	This course marks the ICT layer of the launch case: the digital tools chosen and why, the data handled in spreadsheets and cloud services, the file organisation, and the security and backup of the team's work. 20 marks, team.

What to hand in

- **GBBS445 Global Business Strategy** — A hosted strategy brief and competitor board built with AI tools — industry analysis, positioning map, the entry or expansion option, and the risk table — submitted in session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GBCF435 Corporate Finance** — A working financial model for the launch — a hosted spreadsheet and one-page dashboard built with AI tools, carrying the costing, funding plan, NPV, break-even and sensitivities — submitted in session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GBMK444 Principles of Marketing** — By session 12 a hosted launch microsite for the product — offer, positioning, pricing and a working sign-up or order form, built with AI tools and published at a live URL — with the costed launch plan behind it.
- **GBMN441 Principles of Management** — A hosted launch plan and team dashboard built with AI tools — objectives, milestones, roles and decision rights, the risk register and the control measures with live status — submitted in session 12 with AI declaration.



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Marketing & Numbers · Launch Case CLIENT LANE

continued

- **GBST442 Statistical Inference** — A hosted analysis notebook and one-page results brief built with AI tools — data, code, assumption checks, test output and the plain-language conclusion — submitted in session 12 with AI declaration.
- **GRQR316 Quantitative Reasoning I** — By session 12 a hosted launch-case dashboard built with AI tools — market size, the cost and price model, survey summary charts and a sensitivity table — published with the underlying workbook and AI declaration.
- **GCIC313 Applications of Information & Communication Technologies** — By session 12 the team files an ICT annex to the launch case: the tool stack, the shared data structure, the backup and access record, and a one-page security note.

How big the file is

The written file is **3,000 words for every member**, plus or minus ten per cent — 15,000 words for a team of five, 12,000 for four, 9,000 for three — plus the artefacts: the evidence or data log with its instrument, interview notes and consent log, any program with its tests, the pitch deck, the AI declaration and the draft-to-final revision log. In the venture and client lanes the live thing itself is the largest artefact. Each member owns one section of 3,000 words with their name on it, one artefact they built, and one part they can defend alone at viva. A lens note is 3,000 words on the same project. The full format is in "The Build Block File — required format" in the kit.



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Marketing & Numbers · Launch Case CLIENT LANE

continued

Dates

Session 4	28 Sep	Planning brief issued — twenty minutes of class: the brief, the Ideas Book and the format sheet. Teams locked since session 3. Choose the project, design the instrument or find the client, split the sections.
Guest session	Session 4, 5 or 6	A practitioner from outside the university speaks to your school, on whichever of those three sessions the speaker can make. Attendance is compulsory. Each student writes one page on it for their own file; it is not marked.
Session 7	19 Oct	One-page plan uploaded to the portal: the question, the instrument or the client charter, who owns what. Not marked — it is the gate. This week the convener merges the marking courses' requirements into the file's sections, so the team writes one document and not eight. Clients matched to teams.
Session 8	2 Nov	Build starts. Rubric issued, roles confirmed, team charter uploaded. Build-with-AI workshop for venture and client teams.
Session 9	9 Nov	Scope agreed with the convener. Client or subject confirmed. Your school arranges its industrial visit for some point between now and session 12.
Session 11	23 Nov	Draft review, inside a normal class: each course teacher sees the teams in their own section for about ten minutes each — show what exists, not what you plan. The convener samples three files per block.
Session 12	30 Nov	The artefact goes live or reaches its first complete state.
Session 13	7 Dec	Final file uploaded with its AI declaration. Venture teams evidence the first paying customer. Five of the twenty come off for each week the file is late, in every course marking it, and nothing is accepted after the Karachi Review.
Session 14	14-19 Dec	Vivas in class: each course holds its own, team by team, in its session-14 class — about three minutes per student, on your own part as that course sees it.
The Karachi Review	Tue 15 Dec	Your team exhibits at its own table, across the campus, all day. The day opens with a thirty-minute handover of studies to the public bodies who asked for them; press and industry attend. Ten panels — a teacher and an alumnus each — circulate the exhibition and score you at your table, about eight minutes a team. Not marked separately; the panel sheet goes to every course marking the file.
Weekend	—	Weekend cohorts hold all of the above in their Saturday and Sunday slots; the Karachi Review runs on a weekend afternoon.

Rules for this lane



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Marketing & Numbers · Launch Case CLIENT LANE

continued

What counts as done

A working deliverable in the client's hands, hosted where it needs to be hosted, with the files and accounts handed over and the client's written comment on record.

The client relationship

You get two meetings — one to take the brief, one to show progress — plus a short written comment at the end. Ask for no more. The client owes you nothing and pays nothing, and you may never request a fee.

Confidentiality

Whatever the client marks confidential stays inside the team and the supervisor. Never accept customer records, financial account details or personal data about identifiable people, and never put any of it into an AI tool.

If the client goes quiet

Tell your convener in the same week. Every client-lane block has an internal Greenwich brief as a fallback — the GX record, the alumni directory, Journey 40 and departmental systems all need building.

Marks

You are marked on the work, not on the client's mood. A difficult client, honestly handled and documented, is not a penalty.

Using AI

You are expected to use Claude and similar tools — to research, to build, to draft, to model numbers. Three rules. Check everything a tool gives you before you use it, and record the check. Declare what you used in the AI declaration bound into the file, as the HEC *Framework on the Use of Generative AI Tools* (2026) requires. Be able to explain, at the viva, everything your team built. **Work you cannot explain is not credited to you.** Undeclared use, or use to fabricate data, references or results, is academic misconduct. Never put real client, patient or examinee data, or anything identifying a real person, into a tool.

BLOCK CONVENER

PROGRAMME HEAD

DATE ISSUED